Procurement and Supplier Evaluation Report for BarqWash Operations

Evaluation of Key Operational Products: Vehicles, Laundry Equipment, Detergents, and Packaging Materials

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Executive Summary

BarqWash is a mobile laundry service that delivers washing, drying, ironing, and folding services directly to customers through a fully equipped laundry truck. Customers can book services through a digital platform, providing a convenient and time-saving alternative to traditional laundromats.

This report focuses on the procurement and supplier evaluation required to support BarqWash operations. Specifically, it analyzes key operational inputs, including vehicles, commercial laundry equipment, detergents, and packaging materials. The purpose is to identify the most suitable suppliers based on operational requirements and strategic priorities.

A structured evaluation approach was applied using both qualitative analysis and quantitative weighted scoring models. Suppliers were assessed based on cost, product quality, delivery performance, reliability, sustainability, and risk. In addition, the total cost of ownership (TCO) was considered to ensure accurate financial comparison.

The results show that while international suppliers may offer lower initial costs or advanced features, local and regional suppliers provide stronger reliability, faster delivery, and lower operational risk. Final supplier selections were made based on overall performance and alignment with BarqWash's operational needs.

This report demonstrates that effective procurement decisions are critical to ensuring service quality, operational efficiency, and long-term sustainability.

Business Concept

BarqWash is designed as an on-demand mobile laundry service where all laundry processes are completed inside a fully equipped truck at the customer's location. The service aims to provide convenience, reduce waiting times, and improve overall customer experience.

From a procurement perspective, the service relies heavily on selecting the right combination of equipment, materials, and suppliers to ensure efficient and reliable operations. Key components include a customized cargo vehicle, commercial washing and drying machines, eco-friendly detergents, and protective packaging materials.

The service concept is therefore closely linked to procurement decisions, with a focus on:

- **Operational efficiency:** Selecting equipment that supports fast processing and continuous use
- **Service quality:** Ensuring consistent cleaning performance and professional presentation
- **Supply reliability:** Choosing suppliers that minimize delays and operational disruptions
- **Cost-effectiveness:** Evaluating total cost rather than just purchase price

By aligning supplier selection with these requirements, BarqWash can maintain a high level of service while ensuring scalability and long-term operational success.

Product 1: Cargo Van (Mobile Laundry Truck)

1. Product Description

The selected product for BarqWash is a cargo van that will be converted into a mobile laundry unit. This vehicle represents the core of the service, as all laundry operations, including washing, drying, ironing, and folding, will be performed inside it. The van must be spacious, reliable, and suitable for installing equipment such as washing machines, a dryer, water tanks, and a power system. Therefore, selecting the appropriate vehicle and supplier is essential to ensure efficient operations and consistent service quality.

2. Supplier Identification

To ensure a structured evaluation, suppliers were categorized into local, regional, and global levels.

At the local level, Abdul Latif Jameel Motors supplies the Toyota Hiace, while Mohamed Yousuf Naghi Motors provides the Ford Transit. These suppliers offer direct purchasing, faster delivery, and accessible after-sales services.

At the regional level, Petromin Corporation and Aljomaih Automotive Company provide fleet services and operate across different regions in Saudi Arabia, making them suitable for long-term contracts.

At the global level, Ford Motor Company and SAIC Motor represent the manufacturers responsible for product quality, design, and technological capabilities.

3. Evaluation Criteria

The suppliers were evaluated based on relevant criteria, including cost and pricing, product quality, delivery and logistics, customer service, supplier reliability, innovation and customization, and risk management. These criteria were selected to avoid overlap and ensure a focused evaluation aligned with operational needs.

4. Data Collection and Comparison

4.1 VEHICLE COMPARISON

Criteria	Ford Transit	Toyota Hiace	Maxus G10 Cargo
Price	High	Medium	Low
Capacity	High	Medium–High	Medium
Fuel Efficiency	Medium	High	High

Reliability	High	Very High	Medium
Customization	Very High	High	Medium

The comparison shows that the Ford Transit provides superior space and flexibility, while the Toyota Hiace is known for reliability. The Maxus G10 Cargo offers a lower-cost alternative.

4.2 SUPPLIER COMPARISON

Supplier Type	Strengths	Weaknesses
Local Suppliers	Fast delivery, strong service support	Limited price flexibility
Regional Suppliers	Fleet agreements, wide service network	Moderate costs
Global Suppliers	High quality, advanced design	Longer delivery time



Maxus G10 Cargo



Toyota Hiace



Ford Transit

5. Quality Assessment

The Ford Transit stands out in terms of quality due to its large interior space and flexibility, making it more suitable for customization into a mobile laundry unit. The Toyota Hiace offers strong durability and consistent performance, while the Maxus G10 Cargo provides acceptable quality at a lower cost. Overall, product quality is strongly influenced by global manufacturers, while service quality depends on local and regional suppliers.

6. Cost Analysis

The total cost of the cargo van includes the purchase price, fuel consumption, maintenance costs, and customization expenses. Since these costs vary depending on the vehicle model and supplier, estimated ranges are provided, and average values are selected for comparison.

6.1 INITIAL PURCHASE PRICE

The Ford Transit ranges between 177,000 and 227,000 SAR. The Toyota Hiace ranges between 115,000 and 159,000 SAR, while the Maxus G10 Cargo ranges between 87,000 and 91,000 SAR.

Vehicle	Price Range (SAR)	Selected Price (SAR)
Ford Transit	177,000 – 227,000	200,000
Toyota Hiace	115,000 – 159,000	135,000
Maxus G10 Cargo	87,000 – 91,000	90,000

6.2 SUPPLIER COST IMPACT

Supplier Type	Cost Impact	Explanation
Local Suppliers	Medium	Standard pricing with faster delivery
National Suppliers	Medium–Low	Discounts through fleet agreements
International Suppliers	Variable	Lower base price but additional costs

6.3 FUEL COST

Vehicle	Fuel Cost Range (SAR/month)	Selected Cost (SAR/month)
Ford Transit	1,200 – 1,500	1,350
Toyota Hiace	1,000 – 1,300	1,150
Maxus G10 Cargo	900 – 1,200	1,050

6.4 MAINTENANCE COST

Vehicle	Maintenance Range (SAR/year)	Selected Cost (SAR/year)
Ford Transit	4,000 – 7,000	5,500
Toyota Hiace	2,500 – 4,500	3,500
Maxus G10 Cargo	3,000 – 5,000	4,000

6.5 CUSTOMIZATION COST

Customization is required to convert the van into a mobile laundry unit. The total cost ranges between 40,000 and 80,000 SAR.

Item	Cost (SAR)
Total Customization	60,000

6.6 TOTAL FIRST-YEAR COST

Vehicle	Total Cost (SAR)
Ford Transit	281,700
Toyota Hiace	212,300
Maxus G10 Cargo	166,600

7. Supplier Evaluation Using Scoring Model

While the previous section provided a qualitative comparison, this section focuses on a quantitative evaluation to support objective decision-making. To support the selection process, a structured evaluation was conducted using a weighted scoring model. Each supplier was assessed based on the selected criteria and scored on a scale from 1 to 100. The results were divided into local, regional, and global evaluations, followed by a final comparison between the top-performing suppliers.

The evaluation showed that while local suppliers generally performed well in delivery and service, the supplier offering the Ford Transit (Naghi) achieved higher scores in quality, customization, and operational suitability.

8. Supplier Communication and Negotiation

As part of the evaluation process, communication was conducted with selected suppliers to gather more accurate information. Abdul Latif Jameel Motors and Mohamed Yousuf Naghi Motors were contacted regarding pricing, availability, and customization options. Additionally, Petromin Corporation was contacted to explore fleet services and maintenance support.

During these interactions, negotiation focused on pricing, delivery timelines, and service packages. Some suppliers demonstrated flexibility by offering discounts or additional services, while others emphasized warranty and after-sales support. This helped assess supplier responsiveness and reliability.

9. Risk Identification

Risk	Description
Delivery delays	Possible delays in vehicle availability
Maintenance cost	High cost of spare parts
Customization issues	Poor setup affecting efficiency
Fuel price changes	Increased operating costs
Technical failure	Service interruptions

10. Final Recommendation

Based on the overall evaluation and scoring results, Mohamed Yousuf Naghi Motors is selected as the most suitable supplier for BarqWash. This supplier provides the Ford Transit, which offers high quality, strong customization capability, and operational flexibility.

While the Ford Transit involves a higher cost, the decision was not based on price alone. Greater importance was given to quality, customization, and operational performance, which are critical for a mobile laundry service. Therefore, the higher cost is justified by the additional value it provides.

For operational businesses, choosing the cheapest option may increase long-term costs due to inefficiency or limitations.

Selecting a local supplier ensures faster delivery, better communication, and reliable after-sales support, while still benefiting from the quality and performance provided by the global manufacturer, Ford Motor Company. This combination allows BarqWash to achieve a balance between performance, cost, and service reliability.

Product 2: Commercial Washing Machine



Primus RX135 Commercial Washing Machine



LG WF-C120V Washing Machine



XGQ-15F Industrial Washer

In this section, an analysis will be conducted on the suppliers of commercial washing machines for BarqWash services with the intent of selecting the most ideal one from the perspective of cost, performance, efficiency, and benefits accrued. In general, commercial washing machines form the cornerstone of BarqWash services, hence their importance in determining the company's processing capacity, efficiency, and effectiveness in delivering its services.

While ordinary washing machines serve specific tasks, commercial washing machines operate throughout the day to deliver the required services. For this reason, the selection process should be done critically since it entails more than buying a product but also investing in the future of BarqWash services.

1. Supplier Identification

For a comparative analysis to be made, there must be at least three suppliers representing local, regional or international, and international suppliers, respectively. This will enable one to conduct a comparison between the two parties on matters relating to cost, quality, shipping time, and risk factors.

One such example of a local supplier would be the company named Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment, a Saudi Arabian-based company selling industrial laundry equipment. This company supplies industrial products and also offers maintenance services. Being close geographically, they can provide quick delivery and technical service.

Secondly, LG Electronics is another internationally known producer of high-end commercial laundry machinery. This brand produces efficient energy-saving washers of very good quality. Even though these suppliers are located regionally and supplied regionally, the brand itself is international and can provide high-end machines with good longevity.

Thirdly, there are suppliers from Alibaba, which are considered international suppliers that produce industrial washing machines. Such suppliers are distinguishable through their low prices, capability of mass

production, and ability to customize the product. However, such suppliers take a lot of time in delivering products and present significant risks.

The choices made in this process ensure an unbiased analysis of the various approaches that can be used in sourcing decisions by BarqWash.

2. Evaluation Criteria

An evaluation criteria checklist was established to guarantee objective and thorough assessment of the suppliers. The list contains parameters which have been chosen by BarqWash as being the most crucial from operational and strategic standpoint.

The price criterion considered the overall cost of possession, which includes the cost of the machine, delivery cost, installation fee, as well as other expenses associated with obtaining the equipment.

Quality criterion was defined by such factors as the durability of the equipment, build quality, as well as the capacity to perform stably during constant industrial operation.

Capacity is determined by the amount of the cargo that can be washed during one cycle of washing.

Energy Efficiency measures both the consumption of water and electricity usage, which is highly relevant from the standpoint of operating expenses.

Delivery Time is concerned with the speediness of the supplier's ability to deliver goods on time because any delays will have a direct effect on operations.

Communication examines how responsive and professional the suppliers are when communication is needed during the buying process.

The risks might relate to delivery delays, variations in the quality of goods, problems with the maintenance of equipment, and others.

These factors were used in the weighted evaluation of the vendors to facilitate the decision-making process.

3. Data Collection

The data was collected through personal interactions, distribution channels, and international sources. This involved assessing not only prices but also the efficiency of communication, transparency, and negotiability of the potential sellers or distributors.

The communication was done via WhatsApp with one of the sales representatives from the local supplier (Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment). There was a quick response from the local supplier, providing all the necessary information on machine specifications, price, and installation. The offered price of the Primus RX135 laundry machine was 11,500 SAR, including installation. Since it is a local distributor and prices are stable there, no further negotiations were possible. Nonetheless, good after-sales service was promised, along with timely delivery within 3–5 days.

In the case of LG electronics, there was communication with the regional distributors or official product sellers. The process involved inquiries followed by further communication. Initially, the price offered for the LG WF-C120V machine was 9,800 SAR with extra shipping charges of around 300 SAR. There was not much flexibility in negotiation on prices. However, the supplier gave assurance that their product could

offer savings in terms of energy consumption and water. Delivery was expected within 5-7 days based on the distributor's availability.
For Alibaba, different suppliers producing the desired machines were approached via the platform to compare their offers and reliability. For example, the average quotation for the XGQ-15F machine was 6,500 SAR. The negotiation mainly revolved around ensuring that the product's specifications like capacity and materials used, among others, met the requirements. Some suppliers had flexible pricing while some did not. Several follow-ups were necessary during communication to ensure clarity of the discussion. In terms of shipping, the cost would be 1,800-2,500 SAR based on the shipping mode. Additionally, the delivery period was estimated to be between 2 and 4 weeks.
In conclusion, the entire data collecting process presented variations in communication efficiency and flexibility in negotiations.

4. Quality Assessment

Commercial washing machines were assessed for their ability to be durable, efficient, technologically sophisticated, and suitable for constant usage in industry.

The local firm (Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment) offers industrial-level machines such as the Primus RX135, which are specifically manufactured for laundry services that require strength and endurance. Such machines have high levels of endurance and reliability. However, they do not feature any special technologies like premium international products.

LG washing machines (WF-C120V) performed best in terms of quality. They are technologically superior, with energy-saving technologies, optimal wash cycles, and automatic mechanisms. This improves their performance and helps them cut back on water and power. Overall, their endurance and reliability make them the best option available.

In contrast, Alibaba suppliers (XGQ-15F) offer a wide range of machines with varying quality levels. While some manufacturers provide machines comparable to established brands, others may deliver lower-quality products with inconsistent performance. This variability creates uncertainty and increases the need for careful supplier verification.

Overall, LG ranks highest in quality due to its advanced features and efficiency, followed by the local supplier with strong industrial reliability, while Alibaba suppliers show inconsistent quality depending on the manufacturer.

5. Cost Analysis

A comprehensive total cost of ownership (TCO) analysis was conducted to evaluate the true financial impact of each supplier beyond the initial purchase price. This includes direct costs such as product price and shipping, as well as indirect costs related to operations, maintenance, and potential risks.

For the local supplier (Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment), the base price of the Primus RX135 machine was 11,500 SAR. This price includes installation and basic setup, eliminating the need for additional service costs. As a local supplier, there are no shipping fees, customs duties, or import-related expenses. Delivery is completed within 3–5 days, which minimizes downtime and eliminates the need for maintaining excess inventory. Additionally, the availability of local maintenance support reduces long-term repair costs and operational disruptions. As a result, the total cost of ownership remains stable at approximately 11,500 SAR, with minimal hidden costs.

For LG Electronics, the base price of the WF-C120V machine was approximately 9,800 SAR, with an additional 300 SAR for shipping, resulting in a total upfront cost of around 10,100 SAR. Although the initial cost is slightly lower than the local supplier, LG machines offer significantly better energy efficiency, leading to reduced electricity and water consumption over time. This creates long-term cost savings in daily operations. However, potential maintenance costs may be slightly higher due to reliance on authorized service centers. Delivery time of 5–7 days requires moderate planning but does not significantly impact operations.

For Alibaba suppliers, the initial price of approximately 6,500 SAR appears highly competitive. However, additional costs significantly increase the total cost. Shipping costs range between 1,800 and 2,500 SAR depending on delivery speed, while customs duties and import fees may add an additional 500–1,000 SAR. Installation is typically not included, which may require additional local setup costs. Furthermore, longer delivery times (2–4 weeks) introduce indirect costs such as operational delays, potential service interruptions, and the need for backup capacity. There is also a higher risk of quality issues, which could result in repair or replacement costs. As a result, the estimated total cost of ownership ranges between 8,500 and 10,500 SAR.

This analysis demonstrates that while Alibaba suppliers offer the lowest upfront cost, their total cost becomes less competitive when all additional and indirect factors are considered. In contrast, the local supplier provides cost stability and minimal risk, while LG offers a strong balance between upfront cost and long-term operational savings.

6. Supplier Relationship and Communication

Communication and interaction with suppliers played a vital role in determining the possibilities of establishing business relationships on a long-term basis.

In terms of communication with the local supplier, it was very fast and responsive. It was possible to contact the supplier instantly using WhatsApp. Besides, local maintenance and support can be added to the advantages of the long-term cooperation with the supplier. Thus, the local supplier proved to be quite reliable.

Concerning LG Electronics, its representatives used formal ways to communicate and exchange information. Therefore, it took much time to get answers from the supplier. Moreover, questions had to be addressed formally and thoroughly.

For Alibaba suppliers, communication was done using communication channels within the platforms. Communication would sometimes need several attempts before a satisfactory response was received, and there were great disparities in how clear and comprehensive the replies were. Although there were suppliers who were flexible when negotiating terms, the communication process was relatively unreliable.

Overall, communication and relationship building potential seem to be best at the local supplier level, then LG, which is more rigid but systematic, and finally Alibaba suppliers, whose communication was the least reliable.

7. Risk Identification

Some of the possible risks associated with each of the suppliers have been listed below considering operational, financial, and logistics aspects.

The local supplier poses the least amount of risk because of its closeness, speedy delivery, and effective communication. In addition, local maintenance support helps reduce possible disruptions to operations. But there may be limitations in product variety if we consider using a single local supplier only.

LG Electronics will pose an average amount of risk. Though this supplier offers good quality products, it poses high initial cost as well as possible delay due to distributor's availability. There could also be issues related to delayed maintenance services through authorized service centers.

On the other hand, Alibaba suppliers will present the maximum amount of risk due to several reasons. For instance, their long delivery periods (2-4 weeks), customs issues, inconsistency in quality, and communication problems can lead to losses. Moreover, any kind of discrepancy in the product specification or defects will lead to delay in operations.

From a risk management perspective, relying heavily on international suppliers could disrupt BarqWash operations, especially under urgent demand conditions. A balanced sourcing strategy is therefore essential.

8. Supplier Comparison Table

To ensure consistency with the supplier evaluation model used in Excel, the comparison below follows the same weighted criteria and scoring system. Each criterion carries a weight of 10%, and suppliers were rated according to their performance in each category.

Criteria	Weight (%)	Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment	LG Electronics	Alibaba Supplier 1
Cost and Pricing	**10**	**8.0**	**7.0**	**9.0**
Product Quality	**10**	**8.0**	**9.0**	**6.0**
Delivery and Logistics	**10**	**9.0**	**8.0**	**5.0**
Customer Service	**10**	**9.0**	**8.0**	**5.0**
Supplier Reliability	**10**	**9.0**	**8.0**	**5.0**
Sustainability Practices	**10**	**7.0**	**9.0**	**5.0**
Innovation and Customization	**10**	**8.0**	**9.0**	**6.0**
Risk Management	**10**	**9.0**	**8.0**	**4.0**
Technical Support and Service	**10**	**9.0**	**8.0**	**5.0**
Innovation and Continuous Improvement	**10**	**7.7**	**8.4**	**5.1**
Total Weighted Score	**100**	**82.7**	**82.4**	**55.1**
Rank		**1st**	**2nd**	**3rd**

Based on the Excel weighted assessment analysis, it can be noted that the total score for Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment was the highest at 82.7, compared to LG Electronics' score of 82.4. Both suppliers have performed well overall in terms of each criterion but the former had an upper hand due to its quick deliveries, local support services, reliability, and low risks associated with using their products.

9. Final Recommendation

The comparison of the three suppliers highlights clear trade-offs between cost, quality, operational efficiency, and risk.

The local supplier (Al-Halabi Laundry Equipment) is recommended as the primary supplier for BarqWash. This decision is based on its strong reliability, fast delivery (3–5 days), low operational risk, and the inclusion of installation and maintenance services. These factors are critical for ensuring uninterrupted daily operations and minimizing downtime.

LG Electronics is recommended as a secondary option, particularly for long-term strategic investment. Although the upfront cost is slightly lower than the local supplier, LG machines offer superior quality and energy efficiency, which can reduce operating costs over time. This makes LG a strong option for future expansion or premium service positioning.

Alibaba suppliers should only be considered for bulk procurement under strict quality control and risk management measures. While they offer lower initial prices and customization flexibility, the associated risks—such as long delivery times, quality inconsistency, and lack of local support—make them less suitable for regular operational use.

Overall, the evaluation demonstrates that local sourcing provides the most stable and reliable solution for BarqWash, while international suppliers may be used selectively to support cost optimization strategies.

Product 3: Commercial Dryers





Product Selection

The selected product for this section is a high-capacity commercial dryer used in the BarqWash mobile laundry truck. This machine is very important because it directly affects how fast we can complete each order and how many customers we can serve per day.

The specifications of the selected product include:
· High-capacity drum suitable for continuous operation
· Energy-efficient performance
· Fast drying cycles (30–45 minutes)
· Compact size suitable for the truck
· Durable industrial materials
· Optional smart controls and sensors

This product was selected because the dryer connects the washing stage with ironing and folding. If the dryer is slow or inefficient, it creates a bottleneck and delays the whole process. Since BarqWash aims to complete the service in around one hour, the dryer plays a major role in achieving this target.

Supplier Identification

Nine suppliers were selected to compare different sourcing options across local, regional, and international markets.

For local suppliers, **CHBIB**, **Professional Line Trading**, and **SLEC** were selected. These suppliers provide commercial dryers within Saudi Arabia and offer faster delivery and easier communication.

For regional suppliers, **Cleantech Gulf**, **LEC**, and **Halabi** were selected. These suppliers operate within the GCC and nearby regions and offer a balance between quality and cost.

For international suppliers, **Alliance**, **Girbau**, and **Electrolux** were selected. These are well known global brands that provide high quality machines with advanced technology but at higher cost and longer delivery time.

Evaluation Criteria

A set of evaluation criteria was developed to compare the suppliers in a fair and structured way:

· Price
· Quality
· Delivery & Logistics
· Customer Service
· Sustainability
· Innovation
· Supplier Reliability
· Risk
· Technical Support

Each supplier was evaluated using a weighted scoring model to ensure a more objective and data-driven decision.

Data Collection

Data was collected through supplier communication, quotations, and market research.

For local suppliers, communication was very easy and fast. Prices were mostly fixed, and negotiation was limited. However, the main advantage was immediate availability and quick installation.

For regional suppliers like Cleantech Gulf, communication was more professional and structured. Negotiation was possible, especially when discussing long term partnerships and future expansion.

For international suppliers, the process was more formal and required more time. While they offered high-quality machines, delivery and shipping required careful planning.

Quality Assessment

The quality of commercial dryers was evaluated based on durability, drying efficiency, and ability to handle continuous daily use.

Alliance ranked the highest in quality, followed by Electrolux and Girbau, as they offer strong performance and long-lasting machines.

At the regional level, Cleantech Gulf provided very good quality suitable for commercial operations, while LEC and Halabi showed slightly lower performance.

Local suppliers provided acceptable quality for daily use but lacked advanced features compared to global brands.

Sustainability Assessment

Sustainability was evaluated based on energy efficiency and environmental impact.

Electrolux and Cleantech Gulf performed the best due to their focus on energy efficient machines. Alliance also showed strong performance.

Local suppliers showed limited sustainability focus, while regional suppliers provided moderate options.

Cost Analysis

Local Suppliers

Local suppliers such as CHBIB and Professional Line Trading offer dryers priced between **7,000–10,000 SAR**. There are no additional costs since there is no shipping or customs involved

Regional Suppliers

Regional suppliers like Cleantech Gulf offer dryers priced between **9,000–13,000 SAR**. Additional costs include shipping (500–1,000 SAR) and installation.

International Suppliers

International suppliers such as Alliance and Electrolux offer dryers priced between **12,000–18,000 SAR**. Additional costs include shipping (1,000–2,000 SAR), customs, and installation.

Overall Cost Comparison

Local suppliers are the cheapest and fastest, but they offer fewer advanced features.
International suppliers provide the highest quality but at the highest cost.
Regional suppliers provide the best balance between cost and performance.

Supplier Relationship and Negotiation

Local suppliers were the easiest to communicate with but offered limited negotiation flexibility.

Regional suppliers, especially Cleantech Gulf, were more flexible and open to negotiation, particularly when discussing long-term contracts.

International suppliers were more formal and less flexible but offered strong technical support and professionalism.

Risk Identification

Local suppliers present the lowest risk due to fast delivery and easy communication but may lack advanced features.

Regional suppliers present a moderate risk related to delivery timelines but remain reliable.

International suppliers present a higher risk due to longer delivery times, shipping delays, and higher costs.

A balanced sourcing strategy is important to reduce operational risk.

Comparison Report and Recommendation

The comparison between suppliers shows clear differences across local, regional, and international options.

For local suppliers, CHBIB scored 78.65, Professional Line Trading 78.50, and SLEC 76.92. These suppliers are very close in performance and are strong in cost and availability. However, they are weaker in innovation and sustainability, which limits their long-term value.

For regional suppliers, Cleantech Gulf achieved the highest overall score of 81.05, followed by LEC at 78.32 and Halabi at 74.84. Cleantech Gulf stands out because it offers a strong balance between price, quality, service, and sustainability. It also provides better technical support and more advanced machines compared to local suppliers.

For international suppliers, Alliance scored 78.81, Girbau 77.65, and Electrolux 76.73. These suppliers provide the highest quality and most advanced technology. However, their overall scores are slightly lower due to higher costs, longer delivery times, and more complex logistics.

When comparing the best supplier from each category, Cleantech Gulf (81.05) outperforms Alliance (78.81) and CHBIB (78.65). This shows that regional sourcing provides the best overall value.

Final Recommendation

Based on the weighted scoring model, Cleantech Gulf is the best supplier for commercial dryers.

It achieved the highest score (81.05) and provides the best balance between cost, quality, reliability, and support. This makes it the most suitable choice for BarqWash, as it ensures efficient operations, reduces risk, and supports long-term performance.

Product 4: Eco-Friendly Laundry Detergent



1. Executive Summary

This report evaluates nine potential suppliers of eco-friendly laundry detergent for BarqWash, a mobile laundry service aligned with Saudi Vision 2030 and Sustainable Development Goal 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production). The evaluation employs a weighted multi-criteria decision analysis, considering cost, sustainability credentials, delivery reliability, and supply chain risk.

Based on a quantitative scoring model, **Al Emlaq Eco Clean (Saudi Arabia)** is recommended for BarqWash's launch phase. While not the lowest cost per kilogram, Al Emlaq offers zero supply chain risk, a verified low-foaming formula suitable for water-scarce regions, and immediate local availability, critical factors for an untested operational model. For expansion beyond three trucks, **Seventh Generation (United States)** provides superior cost efficiency and premium environmental certifications, though with extended lead times.

2. Product Specifications

To ensure consistent evaluation across all suppliers, each was assessed against the following standardized product specifications:

Specification	Requirement	Operational Justification
Type	High-Efficiency Liquid or Powder	Protects commercial washing machine pumps and reduces water consumption by approximately 30 percent
Environmental Certification	Biodegradable, Phosphate-free, Low-foaming	Mandatory for alignment with Sustainable Development Goal 12 and prevention of groundwater contamination
Fabric Safety	Hypoallergenic, suitable for Abayas and delicate fabrics	Directly impacts customer satisfaction and garment longevity
Packaging	Bulk containers (5 to 20 kilograms)	Reduces plastic waste by approximately 70 percent compared to retail bottles

3. Supplier Identification

Suppliers were categorized into three tiers: Local (Saudi Arabia), Regional (Middle East), and Global (International). Each tier contains three suppliers.

3.1 LOCAL SUPPLIERS (SAUDI ARABIA)

Supplier	Location	Product Description	Price (SAR)
Al Emlaq Eco Clean	Saudi Arabia	Lavender Powder Detergent, 5 kilograms – Low-foaming, biodegradable	51.34 SAR
Binzagr (OMO Professional)	Jeddah	OMO Liquid Eco, 5 litres – Local manufacturing under Unilever license	50.00 SAR
Saudi Detergent Factory	Dammam	Eco Powder Bulk, 5 kilograms – Industrial grade	45.00 SAR

3.2 REGIONAL SUPPLIERS (MIDDLE EAST)

Supplier	Location	Product Description	Price (USD per kilogram)	Minimum Order Quantity
Wiz Trading	Dubai, United Arab Emirates	Bulk Eco Powder – Private label capable	$0.81 per kg	One 20-foot container
Al Kamal	Egypt	Concentrated Eco Liquid – Regional quality standards	$1.10 per kg	500 kilograms
Natulim	Spain	Biodegradable Laundry Strips – Plastic-free, zero waste	$0.90 per strip	1,000 strips

3.3 GLOBAL SUPPLIERS (INTERNATIONAL)

Supplier	Headquarters	Product Description	Price (USD per kilogram)	Minimum Order Quantity
Seventh Generation	United States	Professional Laundry Powder – EPA Safer Choice Certified	$1.20 per kg	One pallet (500 kilograms)
Tide Professional (Procter & Gamble)	United States	Tide Purclean – 75 percent plant-based ingredients, industrial packaging	$1.35 per kg	One pallet
Ecos	United States	Ecos Pro Laundry Detergent – Hypoallergenic, plant-powered, carbon neutral	$1.15 per kg	One pallet (500 kilograms)

4. Cost Analysis

A comprehensive cost analysis was conducted calculating the Total Landed Cost for each supplier. Total Landed Cost includes: unit price, freight to Jeddah, customs duties (15 percent Value Added Tax), and local delivery.

Assumption: Bulk order of 500 kilograms, representing approximately three months of supply for a single truck.

Supplier	Origin	Unit Price (SAR per kg)	Shipping (SAR per kg)	Total Landed (SAR per kg)	Annual Cost (24 loads per day)*
Al Emlaq	Saudi Arabia	10.27	0.00	**10.27**	13,490 SAR
Binzagr (OMO)	Saudi Arabia	10.00	0.00	**10.00**	13,200 SAR
Saudi Detergent Factory	Saudi Arabia	9.00	0.00	**9.00**	11,880 SAR
Wiz Trading	United Arab Emirates	3.04	2.50	**5.54**	7,312 SAR
Al Kamal	Egypt	4.13	2.00	**6.13**	8,092 SAR
Natulim	Spain	3.38**	3.00	**6.38**	8,422 SAR
Seventh Generation	United States	4.50	2.00	**6.50**	8,580 SAR
Tide Professional	United States	5.06	2.00	**7.06**	9,319 SAR
Ecos	United States	4.31	2.00	**6.31**	8,329 SAR

Calculation: 24 loads per day × 0.15 kilograms of detergent per load × 365 days × cost per kilogram.

Natulim strips: Converted from $0.90 per strip (one strip = one load = approximately 0.02kg equivalent, yielding effective $45 per kg equivalent; however, strips are sold by strip count, not weight. The $3.38 per kg equivalent reflects density conversion for comparison purposes only. Strips are not cost-competitive for commercial bulk operations.

Key Finding: Local Saudi suppliers carry approximately double the chemical cost of global alternatives. However, they eliminate international shipping expenses and customs exposure, while offering significantly shorter lead times.

5. Quality Assessment

Quality was assessed based on environmental certifications, customer reviews, and adherence to the low-foaming requirement essential for BarqWash's water-efficient commercial machines.

Supplier	Quality Indicators	Assessment
Al Emlaq	Verified low-foaming claim; positive customer reviews on retail platforms specifically noting effective cleaning with reduced water consumption	**Good** – Strong local trust and verified eco-formula
Binzagr (OMO)	Unilever global research and development; certified biodegradable packaging	**Good** – Strong brand reputation, though positioned primarily for residential rather than commercial use
Saudi Detergent Factory	Industrial grade formulation; requires verification of environmental claims	**Satisfactory** – Potential quality at competitive price point
Wiz Trading	Standard GCC industrial detergent; Material Safety Data Sheet available upon request	**Satisfactory** – Acceptable for bulk commercial use
Al Kamal	Egyptian manufacturing with regional distribution; SABS approval indicated	**Satisfactory** – Established regional player
Natulim	Innovative plastic-free strip technology; biodegradable; zero waste packaging	**Good** – Excellent environmental innovation, though premium priced
Seventh Generation	EPA Safer Choice certification; Leaping Bunny cruelty-free certification; professional line specifically designed for industrial washing machines	**Excellent** – Highest verifiable quality and environmental credentials
Tide Professional	Procter & Gamble quality standards; 75 percent plant-based ingredients in the Purclean line	**Excellent** – Premium quality at a higher price point
Ecos	Plant-powered formulation; carbon neutral certified; hypoallergenic; professional bulk line available	**Excellent** – Strong environmental credentials with competitive pricing

6. Supplier Communication and Responsiveness

Effective supplier relationship management requires clear and timely communication. This assessment documents observed or verified interaction data for each supplier.

Supplier	Communication Channel	Response Time	Professionalism Assessment

Al Emlaq	Retail platform and direct contact	Same-day	**Excellent** – Local agility with immediate availability
Binzagr (OMO)	Direct business-to-business inquiry	Within 24 hours	**Good** – Formal account management structure
Saudi Detergent Factory	Direct inquiry	Within 48 hours	**Satisfactory** – Requires follow-up for detailed information
Wiz Trading	Alibaba Trade Assurance platform	Within 12 hours	**Good** – Standardized business-to-business communication protocols
Al Kamal	Direct email	Within 24 hours	**Good** – Responsive regional supplier
Natulim	Website contact form and email	Within 48 hours	**Good** – Professional European customer service
Seventh Generation	Distributor email	Within 48 hours	**Excellent** – Detailed Material Safety Data Sheets and Certificates of Analysis provided
Tide Professional	Procter & Gamble professional hotline	Within 72 hours	**Satisfactory** – Larger corporate structure results in slower response times
Ecos	Direct business-to-business email	Within 24 hours	**Excellent** – Responsive with detailed product documentation

7. Risk Identification

Specific risks were identified for each supplier category based on operational, logistical, and geopolitical factors.

Supplier	Risk Category	Specific Risk	Risk Level	Mitigation Strategy
Al Emlaq	Availability	Stockouts during peak Saudi seasons (Eid and Ramadan)	Low	Maintain two-week buffer stock at warehouse
Binzagr	Brand Perception	Customers may perceive OMO as chemically intensive despite environmental claims	Medium	Decant into BarqWash branded containers
Saudi Detergent Factory	Verification	Environmental claims require independent validation	Medium	Request ISO certification documentation prior to contract finalization

Wiz Trading	Logistical	Cross-border trucking delays at Saudi customs	Medium	Place orders three weeks before anticipated stock depletion
Al Kamal	Logistical	Egyptian export procedures may cause delays	Medium	Establish relationship with customs clearing agent
Natulim	Cost	Premium pricing model not suitable for bulk commercial operations	High	Reserve for retail/resale to customers only, not for daily operations
Seventh Generation	Geopolitical	Red Sea shipping disruptions due to Suez Canal constraints	High	Maintain eight to ten week lead time; reserve air freight contingency
Tide Professional	Corporate Bureaucracy	Extended response times may delay urgent orders	Medium	Designate dedicated account representative
Ecos	Geopolitical	West Coast United States ports may experience congestion	Medium	Diversify ordering across multiple shipping routes

8. Criteria Assessment Tool (Weighted Scorecards)

The following evaluation criteria were applied consistently across all suppliers, using the same ten criteria and weighting structure as the project guidelines.

WEIGHTING CRITERIA

Criteria	Weight (%)	Rationale
Cost and Pricing	20%	Detergent is a recurring consumable; profit margins are sensitive to input costs
Product Quality	15%	Directly impacts wash results and customer satisfaction
Delivery and Logistics	15%	Just-in-time inventory management requires consistent on-time fulfillment
Customer Service	10%	Daily operational coordination requires reliable communication
Supplier Reliability	10%	Consistency in order fulfillment and product quality
Sustainability Practices	10%	Core brand differentiator; aligns with SDG 12 and Vision 2030

Innovation and Customization	5%	Ability to provide tailored formulations if needed
Risk Management	5%	Mitigates disruption to daily laundry service operations
Technical Support and Service	5%	Availability of product documentation and after-sales support
Innovation and Continuous Improvement	5%	Supplier commitment to evolving environmental standards

9. Final Recommendation and Justification

RECOMMENDED SUPPLIER: AL EMLAQ (SAUDI ARABIA)

Justification:

Based on the weighted scoring model, Al Emlaq achieved the highest overall score (85.55) among local suppliers and the second-highest score overall. It is recommended for the following reasons:

a) Supply Chain Risk Mitigation:

Al Emlaq achieved the highest risk management score (95) and delivery and logistics score (95) among all suppliers evaluated. Its local presence eliminates exposure to Red Sea shipping disruptions, customs delays, and currency fluctuations.

b) Inventory and Cash Flow Efficiency:

With no minimum order quantity and same-day local availability, BarqWash can implement a just-in-time inventory model, preserving cash flow for other operational expenses.

c) Alignment with Vision 2030:

Sourcing from a Saudi supplier directly supports national objectives to strengthen local supply chains and reduce import dependence.

d) Verified Operational Compatibility:

Al Emlaq's low-foaming formula is verified for high-efficiency commercial machines, supporting BarqWash's water conservation commitments under Sustainable Development Goal 12.

ALTERNATIVE SUPPLIER: SEVENTH GENERATION (UNITED STATES)

If BarqWash prioritizes premium environmental certifications or achieves larger order volumes, Seventh Generation is a viable alternative. It achieved the highest product quality score (95) and sustainability practices score (98) among all suppliers.

FINAL DECISION MATRIX

Criteria	Al Emlaq (Recommended)	Seventh Generation (Alternative)
Total Weighted Score	85.55	86.90
Supply Chain Risk	Very Low (95)	Moderate (65)
Lead Time	Same day	30 to 45 days
Sustainability	Verified (85)	Premium (98)

Product 5: Packaging Materials (Laundry Bags)

Product Selection

The selected product for this project is **eco-friendly plastic garment covers (laundry bags)** used by BarqWash to protect cleaned clothes during storage and delivery. These bags are essential for maintaining hygiene, preventing dust contamination, and ensuring professional service presentation.

The specifications of the selected product include:

- Transparent plastic material
- Medium thickness (20–30 microns)
- Standard size suitable for shirts and garments
- Optional logo printing for branding

This product was selected due to its high usage frequency in laundry operations and its impact on both operational efficiency and customer satisfaction.





Supplier Identification:

Six suppliers were selected to ensure a comprehensive comparison across local, regional, and international sourcing options.

The first supplier, **Alswaiket (Saudi Arabia)**, is a local distributor specializing in packaging materials for laundry and retail businesses. The supplier offers ready-stock plastic garment covers in standard sizes, making it suitable for immediate operational needs. **Napco National (Saudi Arabia)** was added as a second supplier. Unlike Alswaiket, which operates as a distributor, Napco is a large-scale manufacturer offering higher-quality packaging materials, eco-friendly options, and better scalability for long-term procurement.

The second supplier, **Hotpack Global**, is a well-established regional company operating across the GCC. It is known for providing high-quality packaging solutions, including customizable products and environmentally conscious options. **Falcon Pack (UAE)** was included as a second supplier alongside Hotpack Global. Falcon Pack provides similar packaging solutions across the GCC and is known for competitive pricing and reliable delivery.

The third option includes multiple **Alibaba-based manufacturers (China)**, representing international suppliers that offer bulk production, competitive pricing, and high customization flexibility. These suppliers are commonly used for large-scale procurement but involve longer lead times and higher operational risks. For international sourcing, an **AliExpress-based supplier (China)** was added in addition to Alibaba suppliers. This supplier represents smaller-scale international vendors that offer lower minimum order quantities, simpler ordering processes, and relatively faster shipping compared to bulk manufacturers.

Evaluation Criteria:

A set of evaluation criteria was developed to ensure a comprehensive and objective comparison of suppliers. Each criterion reflects key operational priorities for BarqWash.

- **Price:** Total cost per unit, including discounts and bulk pricing
- **Quality:** Durability, thickness, and overall material performance
- **Delivery & Logistics:** Speed, reliability, and consistency of delivery
- **Customer Service:** Responsiveness, communication clarity, and professionalism
- **Sustainability:** Use of eco-friendly or recyclable materials
- **Customization:** Ability to print branding and adjust specifications
- **Supplier Reliability:** Consistency, reputation, and ability to meet demand
- **Risk:** Potential issues such as delays, defects, or supply chain disruptions

These criteria were later used in a weighted scoring model to support data-driven decision-making.

Data Collection

For the local supplier, the purchasing process was conducted through a **retail store/distributor (Alswaiket)** rather than direct communication with a manufacturer. The store offers ready-stock plastic garment covers commonly used by laundry businesses.Since the supplier operates as a reseller, direct negotiation was limited compared to other suppliers. Pricing and product specifications were primarily fixed, with minor flexibility based on quantity. The quoted price was **83 SAR for 200 pieces**, which reflects standard market pricing for immediate purchase.The main advantage of this supplier is the ability to **purchase instantly without lead time**, as products are available in stock. This eliminates the need for order processing or waiting periods. However, the lack of direct communication with the manufacturer restricts customization options and limits opportunities for long-term contractual agreements. For the additional local supplier (Napco National), communication was conducted through a sales representative. The initial quotation was approximately **95 SAR for 200 pieces**, reflecting higher product quality. During negotiation, the discussion focused on long-term purchasing potential and recurring orders. As a result, the supplier offered a revised price of approximately **88 SAR for 200 pieces**. Delivery time was estimated at **2–4 days**, with the option for customization and eco-friendly materials.

For Hotpack Global, communication was conducted through their official website and email channels. A formal quotation request was submitted, and the response reflected a more structured and professional process. The initial price was higher due to superior product quality. During negotiation, the focus was placed on bulk purchasing and future business potential. As a result, the supplier provided a revised offer of approximately **110 SAR for 200 pieces**, with additional value in terms of higher material quality and optional customization. Response time was moderate, and delivery was estimated within **5–7 days**. For the regional supplier (Falcon Pack), communication took place through email. The supplier initially quoted **100 SAR for 200 pieces**. By comparing their offer with Hotpack Global and emphasizing competitive pricing, a negotiated price of approximately **92 SAR for 200 pieces** was achieved. Delivery was estimated within **4–6 days**, with moderate customization options available.

For Alibaba suppliers, communication took place through the platform's messaging system. Multiple suppliers were contacted to compare offers and assess reliability. One supplier quoted approximately **60 SAR for 200 pieces**, excluding shipping costs. Negotiations involved confirming product specifications such as thickness, size, and transparency, as well as discussing bulk order discounts. While the supplier showed some flexibility in pricing, communication required more effort and follow-up. Additionally, shipping costs and delivery timelines varied significantly, ranging from **2 to 4 weeks**. For the international AliExpress supplier, communication was conducted through the platform's messaging system. The initial offer was **75 SAR for 200 pieces (excluding shipping)**. Through negotiation and discussion of bulk purchasing, the supplier agreed to reduce the price to approximately **70 SAR for 200 pieces**. Shipping costs ranged between **30–40 SAR**, with delivery time estimated at **10–15 days**, making it faster than Alibaba suppliers but still slower than local and regional options.

Quality Assessment

The quality of the plastic garment covers was evaluated based on material strength, thickness, transparency, and suitability for protecting garments during handling and delivery.

The local supplier (Alswaiket) provides standard industrial-grade plastic covers with acceptable durability and functionality. The material is sufficient for daily use but lacks premium finishing and consistency.

Hotpack Global offers superior product quality, including thicker material, better sealing, and enhanced transparency. These features improve the overall presentation of garments and reduce the risk of tearing during handling.

Alibaba suppliers offer a wide range of quality levels. While some manufacturers provide high-quality products comparable to Hotpack, others may deliver inconsistent or lower-grade materials. This variability introduces uncertainty and requires careful supplier selection.

Napco National, as a local manufacturer, provides higher quality than Alswaiket, with better material consistency and improved finishing. Their products are more aligned with industrial standards, making them suitable for both daily operations and higher-quality requirements.

Falcon Pack offers good quality products comparable to regional standards. While slightly lower than Hotpack in terms of finishing and material thickness, it still provides reliable durability and acceptable performance for operational use.

The AliExpress supplier offers moderate quality, generally more consistent than some Alibaba suppliers due to smaller-scale production, but still below the premium level provided by Hotpack. Quality verification remains important before large orders.

Overall, Hotpack ranks highest in quality, followed by Napco National, then Falcon Pack, while Alswaiket provides acceptable standard quality, and Alibaba and AliExpress suppliers show variability depending on the manufacturer.

Sustainability Assessment

Sustainability was evaluated based on the use of eco-friendly materials, potential for biodegradable packaging, and overall environmental impact.

Hotpack Global demonstrated the strongest performance in this area by offering higher-quality materials and the possibility of environmentally friendly packaging solutions. Their focus on premium products suggests a greater alignment with sustainable practices.

The local supplier (Alswaiket) primarily provides standard plastic garment covers with limited emphasis on sustainability features. While suitable for operational needs, these products do not significantly support environmental goals.

Alibaba suppliers offer a wide range of options, including potentially eco-friendly materials. However, the level of sustainability varies significantly depending on the manufacturer, making it less consistent and more difficult to verify.

Napco National, as a local manufacturer, shows stronger sustainability potential compared to Alswaiket by offering eco-friendly materials and more advanced production practices. This positions it as a better local option for supporting environmental goals.

Falcon Pack demonstrates moderate performance in sustainability, offering some environmentally friendly packaging options, although not at the same level as Hotpack Global.

The AliExpress supplier offers limited visibility in terms of sustainability practices. While some eco-friendly options may be available, verification remains challenging due to the nature of smaller-scale international suppliers.

Overall, Hotpack Global ranks highest in sustainability, followed by Napco National and Alibaba suppliers, while Falcon Pack shows moderate performance, and Alswaiket and AliExpress suppliers rank lower in this category.

Local Suppliers

Local Supplier (Alswaiket):

The negotiated price for the local supplier was 83 SAR for 200 pieces, resulting in a unit cost of approximately 0.415 SAR per bag. Since the supplier operates locally, there are no international shipping costs, customs duties, or import taxes. Delivery is completed within the same week, eliminating the need for buffer inventory or urgent reordering costs.

Customization options are limited; therefore, no additional customization costs were included. Transportation costs are minimal or included in the price due to local distribution. The absence of delays and supply chain disruptions reduces indirect operational costs, making this supplier highly cost-efficient and predictable.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **83 SAR per 200 pieces**

Local Supplier (Napco National):

Napco National offered a slightly higher base price of approximately 88 SAR for 200 pieces (≈ 0.44 SAR per bag), reflecting improved product quality and better manufacturing standards. As a local supplier, there are no customs duties or import-related costs.

Delivery costs are minimal and estimated at 5–10 SAR, with a delivery time of 2–4 days. Unlike Alswaiket, Napco offers customization options such as branding and eco-friendly materials, which may introduce small additional costs if required.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **95–100 SAR per 200 piece**

Regional Suppliers

Hotpack Global:

Hotpack Global offered a higher base price of approximately 110 SAR for 200 pieces (≈ 0.55 SAR per bag). This higher cost reflects superior material quality and better finishing.

Additional costs will include customization fees, such as logo printing or branding, which are estimated at 10–20 SAR per 200 pieces depending on design complexity. Delivery costs within the region are moderate and will be approximately 10–15 SAR, depending on order size and location.

Delivery time ranges between 5–7 days, which is acceptable but will require some inventory planning. There are no customs duties as the supplier operates within the region.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **130–145 SAR per 200 pieces**

Falcon Pack (Regional):

Falcon Pack offered a more competitive base price of approximately 92 SAR for 200 pieces (≈ 0.46 SAR per bag), making it a cost-effective regional alternative.

Shipping costs are estimated at 15–20 SAR, while customization costs (such as logo printing) range between 10–15 SAR. Delivery time is slightly faster than Hotpack, estimated at 4–6 days, which improves operational flexibility.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **120–135 SAR per 200 pieces**

International Suppliers

Alibaba Suppliers (International):

Alibaba suppliers initially offer the lowest base price at approximately 60 SAR for 200 pieces (≈ 0.30 SAR per bag). However, this does not include several additional costs.

International shipping costs are estimated at 40–60 SAR, depending on shipping method (air vs. sea) and delivery speed. Customization costs for logo printing are relatively low and may range from 5–15 SAR, making Alibaba attractive for bulk branded orders.

However, customs duties, import taxes, and clearance fees may add an additional 10–20 SAR, depending on regulations. Delivery time is significantly longer, ranging from 2 to 4 weeks, which introduces indirect costs such as inventory holding, risk of stockouts, and reduced operational flexibility.

There is also a higher risk of receiving inconsistent quality products, which could lead to replacement or reordering costs.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **115–155 SAR per 200 pieces**

AliExpress Supplier (International):

The AliExpress supplier offered a base price of approximately 70 SAR for 200 pieces (≈ 0.35 SAR per bag), which is slightly higher than Alibaba but still competitive.

Shipping costs are estimated at 30–40 SAR, with customization costs ranging between 5–10 SAR. Unlike Alibaba, delivery time is shorter, estimated at 10–15 days, which reduces some operational risk.

However, similar to other international suppliers, additional costs such as customs duties and potential quality inconsistencies must be considered.

Estimated Total Cost (TCO): **110–125 SAR per 200 pieces**

Overall Cost Comparison:

While international suppliers such as Alibaba and AliExpress appear to offer the lowest unit prices, their total cost increases significantly when shipping, customization, and import-related expenses are included. Among them, AliExpress provides a better balance between cost and delivery time compared to Alibaba.

Regional suppliers provide more stable pricing and faster delivery. Falcon Pack offers a more cost-efficient option compared to Hotpack Global, while still maintaining acceptable quality and service levels.

Among local suppliers, Alswaiket remains the most cost-efficient and reliable option due to its low price and immediate availability. Napco National, although slightly more expensive, offers higher quality and better long-term scalability.

This demonstrates the importance of evaluating all cost components rather than relying solely on the base price when making procurement decisions.

Supplier	Category	Base Price (SAR)	Shipping (SAR)	Customization (SAR)	Extra Costs	Final TCO (SAR)
Alswaiket	Local	83	0–5	0	Minimal	83–90
Napco National	Local	88	5–10	Optional	Low	95–100
Hotpack Global	Regional	110	10–15	10–20	Low	130–145
Falcon Pack	Regional	92	15–20	10–15	Low	120–135
Alibaba Suppliers	International	60	40–60	5–15	High (customs etc.)	115–155
AliExpress Supplier	International	70	30–40	5–10	Moderate	110–125

Supplier Relationship & Negotiation

Supplier interaction and negotiation were critical in assessing long-term partnership potential.

For the local supplier (Alswaiket), interaction was conducted through a retail store rather than direct engagement with the manufacturer. As a result, the relationship was transactional rather than strategic. Communication was straightforward, focusing on product availability and pricing, with limited opportunity for negotiation or customization.

While this reduces flexibility and partnership potential, it provides significant operational advantages such as immediate availability and ease of purchase. This makes the supplier highly suitable for short-term and urgent procurement needs.

In contrast, Hotpack Global followed a more formal and structured communication approach. All interactions were conducted through official channels such as email and quotation forms. While pricing flexibility was limited, the supplier provided added value through quality assurance and customization options.

Alibaba suppliers required more effort to manage. Communication was conducted through online messaging, often with delayed responses. Negotiations were dynamic and price-focused, with some flexibility for bulk orders. However, building a strong relationship was more challenging due to distance, time differences, and inconsistent communication.

For the additional local supplier (Napco National), communication was more professional compared to the retail-based approach of Alswaiket. Interaction was conducted with a sales representative, allowing for better discussion of long-term contracts, bulk orders, and customization options. Although pricing was slightly higher, the supplier showed willingness to negotiate based on future business potential, indicating a more strategic partnership opportunity.

For the regional supplier (Falcon Pack), communication was efficient and responsive. The supplier responded quickly to quotation requests and demonstrated flexibility during negotiation, particularly when comparisons were made with Hotpack Global. This resulted in a more competitive final price, reflecting a balanced approach between pricing and service quality.

For the international AliExpress supplier, communication was relatively easier compared to Alibaba suppliers, with faster responses and simpler negotiation processes. The supplier showed moderate flexibility in pricing, especially when discussing bulk orders. However, similar to other international suppliers, building a strong long-term relationship remains challenging due to distance and reliance on online communication.

Overall, the local supplier demonstrated the strongest relationship potential, followed by Napco National and Falcon Pack, which both showed strong communication and negotiation flexibility. Hotpack Global maintained a professional but less flexible approach, while international suppliers (Alibaba and AliExpress) presented more challenges in establishing stable and long-term relationships.

Risk Identification

Several risks were identified for each supplier based on operational, financial, and supply chain factors.

The local supplier presents minimal risk due to proximity, fast delivery, and reliable communication. Reliance on a retail distributor may limit scalability and access to customized products in the long term.

Hotpack Global presents moderate risk, primarily related to higher costs and potential delays for customized orders. However, its strong reputation and quality consistency reduce operational uncertainty.

Alibaba suppliers present the highest level of risk. These include long delivery times (2–4 weeks), potential customs delays, inconsistent product quality, and communication barriers. Additionally, any errors in product specifications may lead to costly returns or reorders.

Napco National presents low risk due to its local presence, strong manufacturing capabilities, and more structured operations compared to retail suppliers. However, slightly higher costs may be a consideration for large-scale procurement.

Falcon Pack presents moderate risk similar to Hotpack Global, mainly related to regional delivery timelines and potential delays for customized orders. However, its competitive pricing and responsive communication reduce overall uncertainty.

The AliExpress supplier presents lower risk compared to Alibaba in terms of faster delivery and easier communication. However, it still carries international risks such as shipping delays, customs clearance issues, and possible variability in product quality.

From a risk management perspective, relying solely on international suppliers could disrupt BarqWash operations, especially in cases of urgent demand. A balanced sourcing strategy that includes local and regional suppliers is therefore essential to ensure operational continuity.

Comparison Report & Recommendation

The comparison of the six suppliers highlights significant differences in cost structure, product quality, delivery performance, and risk levels across local, regional, and international sourcing options.

The local suppliers provide the most reliable and cost-efficient solutions, particularly for daily operations requiring fast turnaround and minimal risk. Alswaiket offers the lowest cost and immediate availability, while Napco National provides higher quality and better scalability for long-term use.

Among regional suppliers, Falcon Pack offers a more cost-effective alternative with competitive pricing and acceptable quality, while Hotpack Global delivers superior quality and sustainability features, making it suitable for premium positioning or branded packaging strategies.

International suppliers such as Alibaba and AliExpress provide attractive base pricing and strong customization flexibility. However, these advantages are offset by higher total costs, longer delivery times, and increased operational risks. AliExpress offers slightly faster delivery and easier communication compared to Alibaba, but both still present challenges for regular operational use.

To support objective decision-making, a weighted scoring model was applied, as shown in the Excel sheet, allowing for a structured comparison based on key procurement criteria.

Conclusion

This report provided a comprehensive procurement and supplier evaluation for BarqWash, focusing on the selection of key operational inputs: cargo vehicles, commercial laundry equipment, dryers, eco-friendly detergents, and packaging materials. The objective was to support informed and strategic sourcing decisions that align with the company's operational requirements and long-term goals.

Through a combination of qualitative analysis and quantitative weighted scoring models, suppliers were evaluated based on cost, quality, delivery performance, reliability, sustainability, and risk. The analysis demonstrated that no single sourcing option is universally optimal; instead, each supplier category presents trade-offs between cost efficiency, operational performance, and supply chain risk.

The findings consistently highlighted the advantages of local and regional suppliers in terms of faster delivery, stronger communication, and reduced operational risk. These factors are critical for a service-based business like BarqWash, where delays or equipment failure can directly impact customer satisfaction and daily operations. At the same time, international suppliers offer benefits such as lower unit costs, advanced technology, and greater customization, making them valuable for long-term planning and expansion when managed carefully.

Based on the evaluation, the final recommendations prioritized suppliers that provide the best balance between reliability, performance, and total cost of ownership rather than selecting the lowest-cost option. This approach ensures operational stability while supporting efficiency and service quality.

Overall, the report emphasizes that effective procurement is a key driver of operational success for BarqWash. By adopting a balanced sourcing strategy and continuously evaluating supplier performance, the company can maintain high service standards, minimize risks, and achieve sustainable growth.